Hunar: An AI-Assisted Skill Assessment Tool for Recognition of Prior Learning of Domestic Electricians

B.Tech Minor Project Report (Smart India Hackathon 2026 problem statement SIH26242)

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Problem statement: SIH26242, *AI Assisted Skill Assessment Tool for Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)*, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE). **Team:** Tanishq Khandelwal (B.Tech CSE, AIML) and team. *[Team member names and roles to be added.]* **Supervisor:** *[Faculty supervisor name]* **Institution:** *[Department, institute]* **Code and data:** private GitHub repository `Maosama01/hunar`, commit `f81762e`.

> **Integrity statement.** Every number in this report is generated by code in the repository from files in `experiments/`, and the report itself is assembled by `make report`. Where a result does not exist yet the report says **RESULT PENDING**. Results computed on synthetic data are labelled as such and are presented as a check of the pipeline, not as evidence about real workers. All references were checked against their DOI, publisher or official page (`docs/report/references.md`).

Abstract

A large part of India's workforce learned its trade informally and holds no certificate. The Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) route under the National Skills Qualification Framework (NSQF) can certify such workers, but in practice it depends on manual practical assessment, which is slow to scale and inconsistent between assessors. We present **Hunar**, an assessor-support tool for the domestic electrician trade. Hunar (i) maps a worker's free-text self-declaration in English, Hindi or Hinglish to the closest NSQF qualification packs, using performance criteria parsed from the official qualification files on the National Qualification Register, and explains each match; (ii) guides a practical assessment with six task rubrics whose anchored 0 to 3 levels are linked to official National Occupational Standards; (iii) computes explainable pre scores from the assessor's checklist observations and photo evidence, which the assessor accepts or overrides with a reason; (iv) checks evidence photos for reuse with perceptual hashing and, once trained, for the visible presence of protective equipment; (v) produces an NSQF-aligned competency profile and a recommendation that only an assessor's sign-off can finalise, with every action in a hash-chained audit log; and (vi) works offline through an ordered, idempotent sync queue.

On a **synthetic** set of 150 declarations (pipeline check only), keyword and TF-IDF baselines fall to near-chance top-1 accuracy on Hindi in Devanagari (0.25 for TF-IDF; chance 0.20), while a multilingual MiniLM model reaches 0.42. An exploratory hybrid of the two reaches 0.92 top-3 accuracy overall. On real photographs from a public PPE dataset with simulated reuse, perceptual hashing caught every recompressed or resized copy at a false-alarm rate of 0.016 on unrelated photos, but missed cropped, rotated and bordered copies. Spoken declarations are supported: on synthetic text-to-speech audio, Whisper `small` made few errors in English (word error rate 0.05) but many in Hindi (0.43), so the facilitator must read every transcript back to the worker. The central claim of the problem statement, improved agreement between assessors, needs a study with real assessors; Hunar includes the rater mode, photo import and analysis for it, and that result is **pending**. A simulation of the method shows that the planned study (3 to 5 raters, 20 to 30 items) can detect only a large improvement.

Hunar was then extended to workers and customers. Workers log in with a phone number and PIN, give consent per purpose, take an adaptive self-check quiz (electrician, plumber, carpenter) built from official sources, and request a practical assessment; customers find and book workers, and see a "skill assessed" badge only after an assessor's sign-off. Electrical jobs that need a State permit under the CEA Safety Regulations 2023 can be booked only with a worker whose permit was checked. In a simulation of

the method, the adaptive quiz needed 15.4 questions instead of 20 for a similar error; real calibration is pending.

1. Introduction

1.1 Background

India's official labour statistics show how much of the workforce is outside formal employment. The Periodic Labour Force Survey 2025 reports that 73.1% of usual-status workers in the non-agricultural sector work in proprietary and partnership enterprises, which the survey treats as the informal sector [11]. Many of these workers, electricians among them, learned their trade on the job or from family members and have no certificate to show for it.

The National Skills Qualification Framework (NSQF) organises qualifications by level of competence [1], [2], and the National Council for Vocational Education and Training (NCVET), constituted in 2018 [3], regulates them. Approved qualifications and their National Occupational Standards (NOS) are published on the National Qualification Register (NQR) [7]. Recognition of Prior Learning lets an experienced worker be assessed and certified against these standards without repeating training [4], [8], [9], [10]; RPL has also been a component of the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY) [6]. Evidence from an RPL pilot in four Indian sectors shows both the value of RPL and the practical difficulty of running it at scale [60], [61].

1.2 Motivation

The SIH26242 statement identifies the bottleneck: RPL assessment relies on manual practical evaluation, which is slow to scale, inconsistent between assessors and locations, and hard to schedule. It asks for a tool that guides the worker's self-declaration, maps it to qualification packs, supports practical evaluation with checklists and image aids, standardises rubrics to reduce variance between evaluators, generates an NSQF-aligned competency profile for assessor sign-off, and works in low-connectivity settings. It also asks for a clear statement of where the tool supports and where it would replace human judgement.

1.3 Objectives and scope

- Build a working end-to-end flow for **one trade, domestic electrician**, using real qualification files from the NQR: the *Assistant Electrician* qualification (CSDCI, NSQF level 3) as the target and four neighbouring electrical qualifications as distractors.
- Support **English, Hindi (Devanagari) and Hinglish** declarations and an English/Hindi interface.
- Run on an ordinary student laptop on CPU; GPU training on Google Colab.
- Keep the assessor in charge: the tool suggests, the assessor decides, and every decision is traceable.

1.4 Contributions

1. A parser that turns NCVET qualification-file PDFs into structured JSON (5 qualifications, 27 NOS, 345 performance criteria), with source URL, download date and SHA-256.

2. A criterion-level, explainable qualification-pack mapper with keyword and TF-IDF baselines, two multilingual embedding models, and a per-language (fairness) evaluation.
3. Six practical-task rubrics linked to official NOS and performance criteria, and a rubric engine with transparent pre-score rules, tested aggregation maths, the official pass mark and a safety-critical blocking rule.
4. An evidence-integrity evaluation of perceptual hashing on real photographs.
5. An offline-first application with an append-only, hash-chained audit trail.
6. A ready-to-run protocol, rater mode, photo import and analysis for measuring inter-assessor agreement, sized with a simulation of the method.
7. Optional spoken declarations with a read-back safeguard, checked end to end on synthetic speech.
8. A two-sided extension for workers and customers: phone and PIN login with itemised DPDP consent, an adaptive self-check quiz for three trades built on official sources, booking that respects the CEA permit rule, and badges that only an assessor's sign-off can produce.

2. Literature review

RPL policy and practice. UNESCO's guidelines describe recognition, validation and accreditation of non-formal and informal learning as a route to lifelong learning [8]. ILO work identifies the success factors of RPL systems, including credible assessment, trained assessors and quality assurance [9], [10]. India's RPL guidelines define the process under NCVET [4], aligned to the NSQF [2] and the National Credit Framework [5]. Rothboeck et al. study an Indian RPL pilot across four sectors [60], and Singh and Ehlers compare RPL policy in Denmark and India [61]. Rambharose surveys the role of artificial intelligence in RPL and the opportunities it opens for adult assessment [62]. To our knowledge there is little published work that evaluates an AI tool inside an Indian RPL assessment; this is the gap Hunar addresses at prototype scale.

Matching text to skills and occupations. Taxonomy-driven job matching is well established in Europe through ESCO [18]. Skill extraction from job postings has been studied with annotated corpora such as SkillSpan [19], with representation learning for job titles [20], with multilingual taxonomy-driven pre-training [22], and is surveyed in [21]. These works match job *postings* to a taxonomy; Hunar instead matches a worker's own description of their experience, written informally and often in Hindi or Hinglish, to the performance criteria of Indian qualification packs.

Sentence embeddings. BERT [17] enabled contextual representations; Sentence-BERT made them efficient for semantic similarity [13]. Reimers and Gurevych extended sentence embeddings to many languages by knowledge distillation [14]; the `paraphrase-multilingual-MiniLM-L12-v2` model we use comes from that work and is built on the compact MiniLM architecture [16]. LaBSE is a language-agnostic alternative trained for translation retrieval [15]. Lexical baselines are TF-IDF weighting [23] and BM25 [24]; mean reciprocal rank comes from question-answering evaluation [25].

Code-mixed Hindi-English. Hinglish is common in informal writing [27] and remains hard for NLP models [26], [28]. Our per-language evaluation therefore treats language as a fairness dimension: a tool that works only in English would exclude the workers RPL is meant for.

Visual evidence. YOLO introduced single-stage real-time detection [29]; Ultralytics YOLOv8 is a widely used implementation [30]; mAP follows the COCO protocol [31]. PPE detection on construction sites has been studied with deep learning [32], [33], [34]; Wang et al. also report that detection accuracy drops when faces are blurred [34], which matters for Hunar because it blurs faces for privacy. Face

detection for blurring builds on Viola and Jones [58], and large-scale automatic face blurring was deployed in Street View [59].

Evidence integrity. Perceptual hashes map visually similar images to nearby codes [35], [36], [37]; Farid gives a recent overview of their strengths and failure modes [38]. We use the ImageHash library [39].

Assessor consistency. Agreement beyond chance is measured with Cohen's kappa [40], Fleiss' kappa for many raters [41] and Krippendorff's alpha, which handles ordinal data and missing ratings [43], [44]; interpretation conventions [42] and tutorials [45] are widely used, and bootstrap confidence intervals [46] suit small samples. Scoring rubrics can improve reliability when they are analytic, topic-specific and come with anchors and rater training [47]. Behaviourally anchored scales [48] and frame-of-reference training [49] are classic ways to align raters, and assessor inconsistency has been documented in vocational qualifications [50].

Human-AI decision support. Guidelines for human-AI interaction stress showing why the system did what it did and making it easy to correct [51]. Automation bias, where people over-accept automated suggestions, is a known risk [52] and motivates both our explanations and our audit of overrides. Interpretability should be evaluated against the task it supports [53].

Audit and offline operation. Tamper-evident logging with hash chains dates back to Schneier and Kelsey [54], with efficient structures later proposed by Crosby and Wallach [55]. Local-first software argues for keeping data usable on the device without a connection [56]. Whisper offers multilingual speech recognition trained on large amounts of weakly supervised web audio [57]; Hunar uses it through the faster-whisper reimplementation [64] for optional spoken declarations.

3. Problem definition

Input. A worker w gives a free-text declaration d in English, Hindi or Hinglish. An assessor observes practical tasks and records a checklist, and may capture consented photos.

Outputs.

1. A ranked list of qualification packs P from the set {target, distractors}, with, for every top pack, the declaration sentences matched to each performance criterion (PC) and the core PCs with no match (skill gaps).
2. For every rubric criterion c, a suggested level $\hat{s}(c) \in$ {0, 1, 2, 3, none}, a confidence and plain-language reasons.
3. A final level $s(c)$ per criterion chosen by the assessor, NOS-level and overall scores, and a recommendation for the assessor's sign-off.

Constraints. No automatic certification; overrides need reasons; tamper-evident records; faces blurred before storage; works offline; runs on CPU; the vision model reports presence only.

Evaluation questions. *Q1.* How accurately does the mapper rank the correct pack (top-1, top-3, MRR), and is it equally good in all three languages? *Q1b.* How much do speech-recognition errors change the mapping when the declaration is spoken (pipeline check on synthetic speech)? *Q2.* How reliably does perceptual hashing flag reused evidence without false alarms? *Q3.* How well does the detector find PPE (mAP50, mAP50-95)? *Q4.* Do assessors agree more with the rubric and pre scores

than without them? *Q5*. How precisely, and in how many questions, can an adaptive quiz estimate a worker's knowledge before its items are calibrated (simulation of the method)?

4. Methodology

4.1 Qualification data

We downloaded the official qualification files of five NQR qualifications (Table 1), recorded the URL, date and SHA-256 of each, and parsed the *Module Summary* and *Detailed Assessment Criteria* tables with `pdfplumber`. The NOS name sits in a vertically merged cell, so its text can appear anywhere inside a NOS block, even on the next page. The parser therefore groups rows into blocks at "Total" rows or PC-number restarts and assigns NOS codes by matching title tokens against the module summary with an optimal assignment. Quirks of the official files (a NOS table printed twice, a row repeated across a page break, two inconsistent NOS codes) are handled and documented. The parsed criteria have been spot-checked by us against the PDFs; a complete human check is still pending.

Role	Qualification (NQR code)	Awarding body	NSQF	NOS	PCs
target	Assistant Electrician (QG-03-CO-03951-2025-V2-CSDCI)	Construction Skill Development Council of India (CSDCI)	3	8	112
distractor	Industrial Electrician (QG-04-PW-00870-2023-V1-PSSC)	Power Sector Skill Council (PSSC)	4	8	109
distractor	Rooftop Solar PV (Installation & Maintenance) (NG-03-PW-02710-2024-V1-DGT)	Power Sector Skill Council (PSSC)	3	5	18
distractor	Wireman Control Panel Electronics (QG-03-EH-04474-2025-V2-ESSCI)	Electronics Sector Skills Council of India (ESSCI)	3	3	51
distractor	Jr. Technician (Smart Energy Meter) (QG-03-PW-00868-2023-V1-PSSC)	Power Sector Skill Council (PSSC)	3	3	55

Table 1. Qualifications used. Source: `data/processed/qp/*.json`, `data/qp_sources.json`.

4.2 M1: qualification-pack mapper

The declaration is split into sentences (and long run-on sentences into clauses). A similarity function gives a matrix between declaration units and all 345 performance criteria. The aggregation was fixed **before** any evaluation: the score of a pack is the mean, over declaration units, of the best similarity to

any *core* PC of that pack. A declaration is partial, so we measure how well a pack explains what the worker said, not how much of the pack they mentioned. For explanations, each PC gets the best similarity of any unit; a PC is "matched" above a display threshold (0.4 for MiniLM, set so that explanations are not empty; it does not affect ranking or any metric), and unmatched core PCs are reported as gaps.

Similarity functions: **keyword** (binary bag-of-words cosine after stop-word removal and light stemming), **TF-IDF** (unigrams and bigrams, IDF fitted on all PCs) [23], **MiniLM** (`paraphrase-multilingual-MiniLM-L12-v2`, the pre-declared primary model) [14], [16], and **LaBSE** [15]. After seeing the first results we added an **exploratory hybrid** (mean of TF-IDF and MiniLM similarities); it is reported separately because it was designed after looking at the data.

Evaluation data. The team has not yet written the planned 150 real declarations. To test the pipeline we generated a **synthetic** set of 150 declarations (10 per pack and language) with an AI model that saw only the job titles and one-line job summaries, never the performance criteria, so it could not copy official wording. 16 % are "hard" cases that mention neighbouring trades. A labelling tool and guidelines for the real set are in the repository (`docs/labelling_guidelines.md`).

Metrics. Top-1 accuracy, top-3 accuracy and mean reciprocal rank [25], overall and per language, with 95 % bootstrap confidence intervals over declarations [46]. Ties (for example all-zero scores from a lexical baseline on Devanagari text) are scored as the expected value under a random order of the tied packs, so a baseline cannot gain credit from the order in which packs are listed.

Spoken declarations. Many workers find it easier to speak than to type. The facilitator can record the worker on the declaration screen; the audio is sent once to the server, transcribed with Whisper `small` [57] through faster-whisper [64] on the CPU (8-bit weights, voice-activity filtering, language set from the worker's preferred language), and deleted at once. The transcript is only a draft: it appears in the text box, and the declaration cannot be saved until the facilitator confirms that they read it back to the worker and corrected it. The mapper only ever sees the checked text. To check the pipeline without recording anyone, each synthetic declaration was read aloud by a macOS text-to-speech voice (Hindi: *Lekha*; English and Roman-script Hinglish: *Rishi*, an Indian English voice, which read Hinglish far more intelligibly than *Lekha* in a spot check), transcribed with the app's settings, and mapped with MiniLM. We report word and character error rates (English and Hindi; for Hinglish the reference is Roman script while Whisper writes Hindi speech in Devanagari, so an error rate would mostly count the script change) and the mapper's accuracy on the transcripts next to the same declarations typed. Clean synthetic speech is far easier than a worker speaking on a noisy site, so these figures are an optimistic bound.

4.3 M3: rubrics and pre scores

Six practical tasks for the Assistant Electrician qualification were written as YAML rubrics: (1) PPE, isolation and test before touch; (2) single-phase switch-board wiring; (3) conduit laying; (4) straight-through joint and insulation; (5) continuity and insulation testing with fault finding; (6) a small distribution board with MCBs. Each criterion lists the official NOS and PCs it covers (validated automatically against the parsed pack), a weight, a critical (safety) flag, the checklist items an assessor observes and four anchored level descriptors in the spirit of behaviourally anchored scales [48]. Hindi translations are provided for titles, instructions and checklist items. The level descriptors were drafted by the team with AI assistance and **must be reviewed by a certified assessor** before real use.

For the two-sided extension (section 4.6) the same format was used for four plumber tasks against Plumber - General (NQR 12957): safe preparation and water shut-off, cutting and joining a supply pipe with a leak check, a trap and waste pipe with the right fall, and repairing a leaking fixture. There are also four carpenter tasks against Assistant Carpenter (NQR 9884): bench and power-tool safety, measuring and cutting to a drawing, a frame joint, and fitting hinges and a lock. Every criterion is linked to NOS and PC codes in that trade's parsed file, which a test checks. These eight tasks are **DRAFTS written with AI help**, say so on screen, and need review by an assessor of each trade. An assessment carries its trade and uses only that trade's tasks. The pass rules come from each qualification file: 70 % aggregate for all three, and for the carpenter file also 70 % in each NOS covered by the tasks.

Pre-score rules are deliberately simple and shown to the assessor:

- checklist items observed by the assessor drive the level: none ticked gives 0, some give 1, all give 2;
- the engine never suggests 3 (proficient), which is left to the assessor's judgement;
- photo detections are reported as reasons ("gloves detected in photo p1, confidence 0.91"). With no checklist they can suggest at most level 2 for presence-type criteria at low confidence, and a disagreement with the checklist is flagged as a conflict;
- the self-declaration is shown as context only and never raises a level;
- with no observed evidence the engine makes no suggestion.

Aggregation: criterion score = level / 3; NOS and overall scores are weighted means; the pass mark is the official **70 % aggregate** stated in each qualification file, plus the carpenter file's 70 % per NOS; any critical criterion below level 2 blocks a positive recommendation. All of this is covered by unit tests, including the edge cases (all zeros, exactly at the pass mark, one NOS below its pass mark, missing scores, invalid levels, weights).

4.4 M2: evidence checker

Privacy. Consent must be confirmed before a photo is accepted. Faces are detected with OpenCV's Haar cascades [58] and blurred **before** anything is written to disk.

Reuse detection. For every stored photo we compute pHash and dHash [35], [39]. A new photo whose pHash is within a Hamming threshold of a photo from *another worker's* assessment is flagged for the assessor; nothing is rejected automatically. We evaluated four hashes on the test split of a public PPE dataset (CC BY 4.0). Because that split turned out to be dominated by near-identical video frames, we first grouped near-identical images with an independent measure (32×32 thumbnail correlation), kept one per group, and drew stored ("gallery") and fresh photos from different groups. Each gallery photo was re-submitted after one of nine transformations (recompression, resizing, cropping, brightness, rotation, a messaging-app style border, mirroring). The threshold was chosen on a development half as the highest recall with at most 5 % false flags on fresh photos, and is reported on the held-out half.

Presence detector. A YOLOv8n model [29], [30] is fine-tuned on Colab on the same public PPE dataset (classes mapped to helmet, gloves, safety shoes, goggles), optionally with the team's own labelled photos of electrician tools. CPU inference is wired into the application. **The detector reports presence only and does not judge workmanship.**

A first training run on the dataset's *published* splits exposed a data problem: the splits are class-disjoint. The published training split has 0 helmet boxes and 14 safety-shoe boxes, while the published test split

has 0 glove boxes, and 136 test images have a near-duplicate in training. We therefore pool all 11978 images, group near-identical frames (pHash within 4 bits, single linkage) and assign whole groups to train, validation and test with iterative stratification [63], taking the rarest class first and aiming at 70/15/15 of the boxes of every class. A looser 8-bit grouping chained whole videos into a single group of thousands of images, which made a balanced split impossible. The dataset is dominated by a few videos (all safety-shoe boxes come from two of them), so a leakage-free split can only train on one shoe video and test on the other. The re-split code is unit-tested in the repository and embedded verbatim in the Colab notebook.

4.5 M4: consistency study protocol

To answer Q4 we will run a within-subject study with 3 to 5 real assessors (not members of the team who wrote the rubrics) on 20 to 30 consented evidence items. Each assessor scores every item twice: first **unassisted** (own judgement, level names only) and, after a gap of at least one week, **assisted** (anchored descriptors and the tool's pre score with reasons). Item order is randomised per rater and condition but reproducible. Agreement is measured per condition with Fleiss' kappa [41], ordinal Krippendorff's alpha [43], [44] and pairwise exact and within-one agreement, with bootstrap CIs over items [46], and the assisted-minus-unassisted difference in alpha is bootstrapped over items rated in both conditions. The analysis code is tested on simulated data inside the test suite. Consented photos are loaded with a checked import (`make study-items`) that refuses rows without a consent-form number, blurs faces, strips photo metadata, computes the assisted-condition pre score with the app's rubric engine and logs each item; the team's procedure is in `docs/m4_study_walkthrough.md`.

Sizing the study (simulation of the method, not a result). To choose the number of raters and items, we simulated the planned analysis under stated assumptions: true item levels drawn from a fixed distribution, raters who differ by a personal bias and by random noise, and noise set so that a very large study would have an ordinal alpha of 0.50 without the rubric and 0.50 (no effect), 0.60, 0.70 or 0.80 with it. For each design (3 to 5 raters, 20 to 30 items) we ran 500 simulated studies through the same paired item bootstrap and counted how often the 95 % interval of the improvement excluded zero. These are artificial ratings; they say nothing about whether the rubric helps, only how precise a study of a given size can be.

4.6 Workers and customers: accounts, quiz and booking

The problem statement is about assessment, but a certified skill only helps a worker if customers can find and trust them. Hunar was therefore extended to two kinds of user: workers (electricians, plumbers, carpenters) who want an honest picture of their skills, and customers who want to book someone whose skills were checked. The design rests on desk research summarised in `docs/research/two_sided_app_research.md`.

What "verified" means. Platforms in India mostly verify identity, not skill, and RPL evidence has been weak: a CAG audit of PMKVY found reused photos and missing geotags. Hunar's customer-facing badge says exactly what was checked: "practical skills assessed by an assessor against on , not a government certificate". It appears only when an assessor, logged in with an assessor account, signs off a positive recommendation through the M3 flow. The quiz never produces a badge. An assessment is scored only on its own trade's practical tasks and against its own trade's qualification file. The M1 pack suggestions are electrical, so a plumber's or carpenter's assessment skips them and the assessor confirms that trade's file. Without this, an electrician's tasks would be scored and the badge would name an electrical qualification. A trade with no rubric tasks cannot ask for a practical assessment at all.

Who may do electrical work. Regulation 31 of the CEA Safety Regulations 2023 [65] allows installation work, including repairs and alterations, only by a State-licensed contractor and a permit holder, except like-for-like replacement of lamps, fans, fuses, switches, fittings and appliances up to 250 V. Each electrical job in the booking catalogue is marked accordingly, and a job that needs a permit can be booked only with a worker whose permit document an admin has checked. A self-declared permit is shown as self-declared.

Accounts and privacy. Workers and customers log in with a phone number and a 4-6 digit PIN. The PIN is stored as scrypt over an HMAC with a server-side pepper and a per-account salt, because a short PIN alone could be brute-forced from a leaked database; five wrong PINs lock the account for 15 minutes. An SMS one-time code can be switched on with a configuration setting once a gateway is available. Consent follows the DPDP Act 2023 [66]: one consent per purpose (account, assessment, profile display, contact sharing), each listing its data items and saying whether it is required (assessment is required for workers, because every worker takes the quiz); withdrawal is one action and triggers hiding or erasure; only adults register; audit entries name accounts by id, never by phone or name; and a phone number is shown to the other party only after a booking is accepted. Staff accounts (facilitator, assessor, admin) are created on the server, and every assessor-side endpoint, including offline sync, now uses the logged-in account as the actor instead of a name sent by the client.

The quiz comes first. The quiz is compulsory for workers. A worker chooses a trade while registering, and creating the account starts the first quiz in that trade. Until one quiz is finished, the app shows only the quiz and the privacy settings. The server enforces the same rule: it refuses a profile, a customer listing, a booking or an assessment request. Changing to another trade needs that trade's quiz first. What counts is finishing at a reading pace, not the score. There is no pass mark, so the rule asks every worker to take part without turning the quiz into a test of ability. But a compulsory quiz invites rushing, so a finished quiz counts only if at least half of its answers were given slower than the rapid-answer threshold. This share is the quiz's response-time effort [72]; the threshold of one half is our choice, not a published standard. A rushed quiz shows the worker how many answers were too quick and asks them to take it again. The assessor sees the latest quiz that counted and how many did not, and calibration leaves rushed quizzes out. How often workers rush, and whether one half is the right line, can only be measured on real attempts.

The self-check quiz. Each trade has a bank of multiple-choice questions written from official sources: the trade's qualification file and its performance criteria (CSDCI Assistant Electrician, WMPSC Plumber - General [77], FFSC Assistant Carpenter [78]), the CEA regulations, Indian Standards such as IS 5329 [79] and IS 2065 [80] (cited by clause, paraphrased), and the DGT curriculum [76] as a topic source. Every item names its NOS, criteria and sources; all banks are marked DRAFT until a certified assessor or ITI instructor reviews them. The quiz is adaptive. Ability is on a Rasch scale, chosen because it needs far fewer respondents to calibrate than two- or three-parameter models [67], [68]; it is estimated by EAP with a standard normal prior [69], and the posterior SD is reported with it. The next question comes from the NOS furthest below its share of the qualification's weightage [70], then, at random among the three items closest to the current estimate, to spread exposure. The quiz stops when the posterior SD is at most 0.5 after at least 12 scored answers, or at 25 questions. Item difficulties start as AI-drafted estimates labelled uncalibrated and act as priors [71]; once 100 real attempts exist, `make quiz-calibrate` re-estimates them by MAP and writes a new, versioned parameter set (never changed during a quiz). Answers given faster than the question can be read are recorded and flagged but not scored [72], and a "don't know" option reduces guessing. Options are shuffled per attempt, the answer key never reaches the device, and the worker sees a range ("likely X-Y % of our questions") with

topics to revise, never a pass or fail. Assessors see the latest quiz summary as context when they pick up a worker's assessment request.

Languages and accessibility. The app offers English and the 22 languages of the Eighth Schedule, each named in its own script, with right-to-left layout for Urdu, Kashmiri and Sindhi. Interfaces for low-literacy users work better with icons, short text and voice than with text alone [73], [74], so the screens use large icon cards and read questions aloud. Translation and text to speech use Bhashini [75] from the server, so the keys never reach the browser; a batch script writes machine translations marked "not reviewed", and the app labels them and falls back to English or Hindi where a translation is missing.

4.7 Where the tool supports and where it does not replace human judgement

Decision	Tool	Assessor
Which qualification pack applies	Ranks packs, shows matched sentences and gaps	Confirms the pack; a different choice needs a reason
Whether a step was performed	Suggests a level from the assessor's own checklist	Accepts or overrides with a reason
Whether PPE/tools were present	Reports detections with confidence (presence only)	Resolves conflicts; judges use and quality
Workmanship and proficiency	Never judged; never suggests level 3	Sole judge
Whether evidence is reused	Flags near-identical photos	Decides whether it is misconduct
Whether a part was explained in a guided clip (video pilot)	Finds the words for each aspect with timestamps; compares a typed meter reading with the printed value	Watches the marked moments; judges whether the explanation and the work are right
Recommendation	Computes scores, pass mark, safety block	Signs off, agreeing or recording an own outcome with a comment

4.8 Video pilot: guided clips (built, not yet tried with real workers)

A team proposal to grade a worker's video of an appliance repair led to a pilot with one change of design: instead of one long video, the app asks for short clips, one per part. For a ceiling fan these are the capacitor, winding, bearings and regulator, plus a planted fault and a run test. For each clip the server blurs faces in every frame, removes the sound, stores only that copy, and transcribes the speech with word timings. It then looks for the words that show each aspect was explained (name, function, failure, test) in English, Hindi and Hinglish, and compares a meter reading the worker types with the value printed on the part. An optional frame check prompts the open-vocabulary detector YOLOE [81] with the part's name and with "hand" on about one blurred frame a second, and lists the moments when the part was in view and when a hand box overlapped it. It shows presence and handling only, never workmanship. These become reasons for a suggested level, at most 2, with low confidence while the frame check is not set up (its weights are downloaded separately with `make clip-models`); the assessor watches the marked moments and decides. The four fan tasks are drafts linked to Service Technician - Home Appliances (NQR 14861). No current qualification we checked names ceiling fans, so they use that file's general diagnose-and-repair criteria. A test runs the whole pipeline on a synthetic clip (generated frames, a stand-in transcript); another runs the frame check with a stand-in model. RESULT

PENDING: speech accuracy per engine, and frame-check precision and recall on hand-labelled frames from about 20 consented team recordings (`make clip-frames`, then `make eval-clips`).

5. System design

Hunar is a FastAPI backend with SQLite (via SQLModel) and a React progressive web app (Figure 1). The ML modules sit behind service interfaces, so models can be swapped without touching the API.

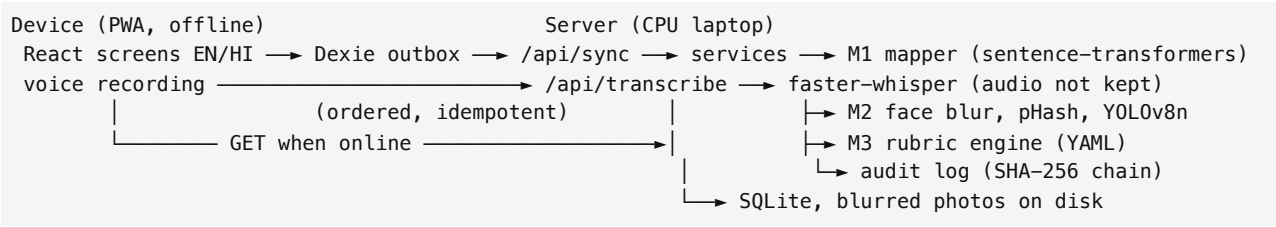
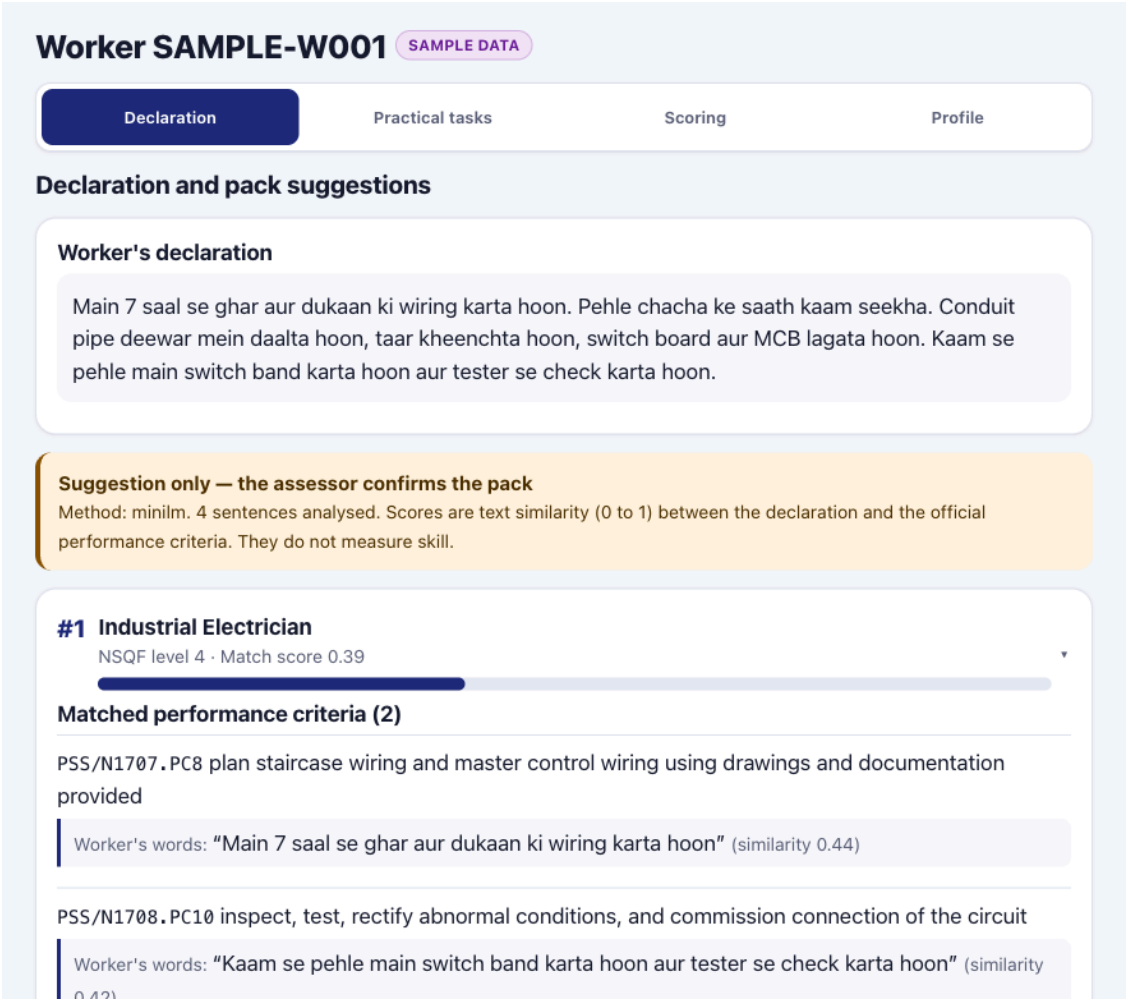


Figure 1. Components. Mermaid diagrams are in `docs/architecture.md`.

Offline operation. Every write goes through a durable IndexedDB outbox. Records created offline get client-generated UUIDs, so later operations can refer to them before they reach the server. The sync endpoint applies operations in order, records each operation id so a replay is ignored, and stops at the first rejected operation so dependent operations are not applied out of order. Mapping needs the server, so a declaration typed offline is matched after sync. Speech recognition also needs the server; offline, the record button is disabled with a note asking the facilitator to type.

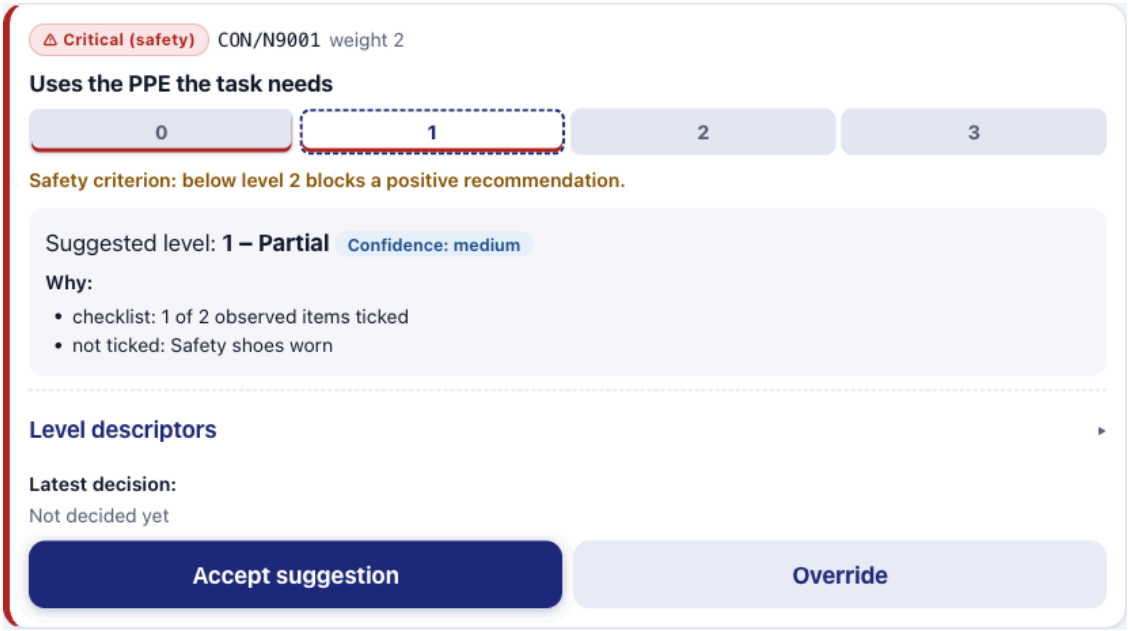
Audit trail. Each audit entry stores the SHA-256 of the previous entry; editing any past entry breaks the chain, which `/api/audit/verify` detects, and SQLite triggers refuse UPDATE and DELETE on the table. A test shows that even an attacker who drops the trigger and edits an entry is detected.

Interfaces. The React PWA (TypeScript, Vite, Dexie) has these screens: worker/facilitator declaration (typed or recorded) with explained mapping; practical tasks with checklist and consented photo capture; assessor scoring with anchors, pre scores, reasons and accept/override; competency profile and sign-off; admin audit view with chain verification; rater mode for the study; and a sync-queue view. The interface is in English and Hindi, and sample data is badged “SAMPLE DATA” everywhere. The full flow was exercised in a browser at phone width (360 and 375 px), including creating a worker, declaration, checklist ticks and a photo with the network off and replaying them in order after reconnecting.



Declaration screen with explained mapping (sample data)

Figure 2. Declaration screen for the SAMPLE worker. The top suggestion is wrong (Industrial Electrician); the assessor sees the matched sentences and confirms the correct qualification.

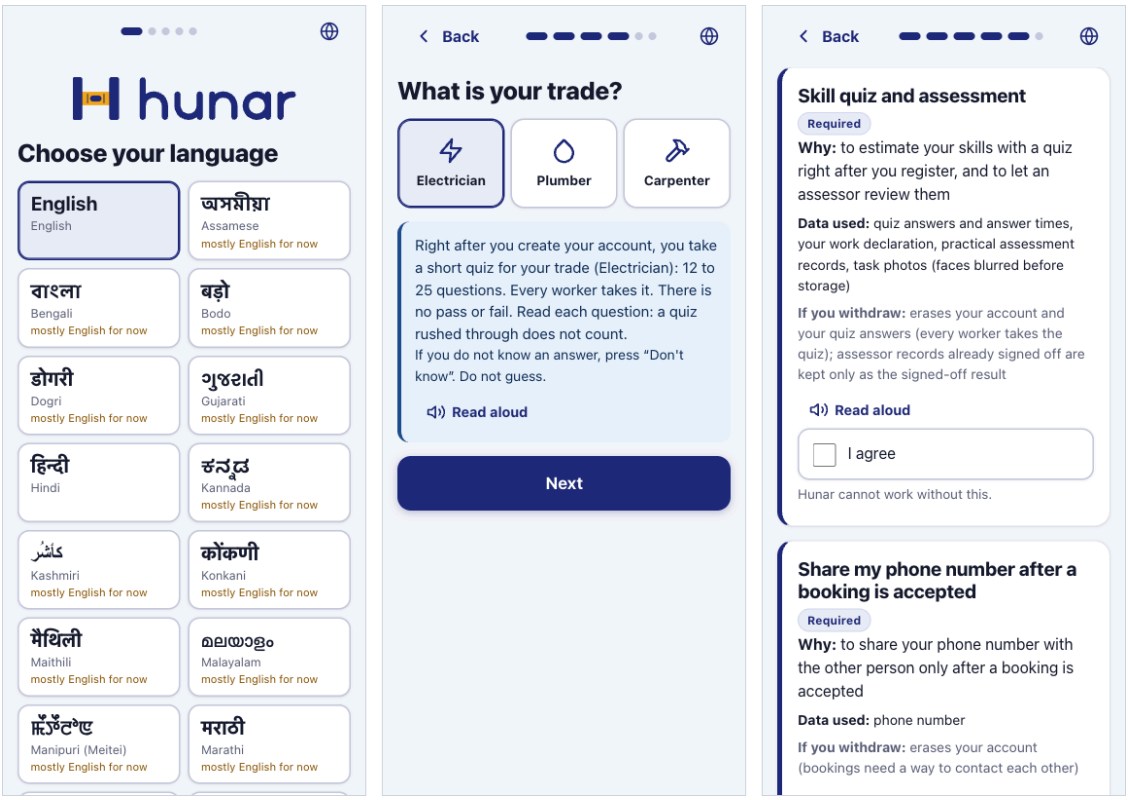


Scoring screen: explainable pre score

Figure 3. One criterion on the assessor's scoring screen: safety flag, a level strip (dashed: the tool's suggestion; red underline: the levels that block a positive result on a safety criterion), suggested level

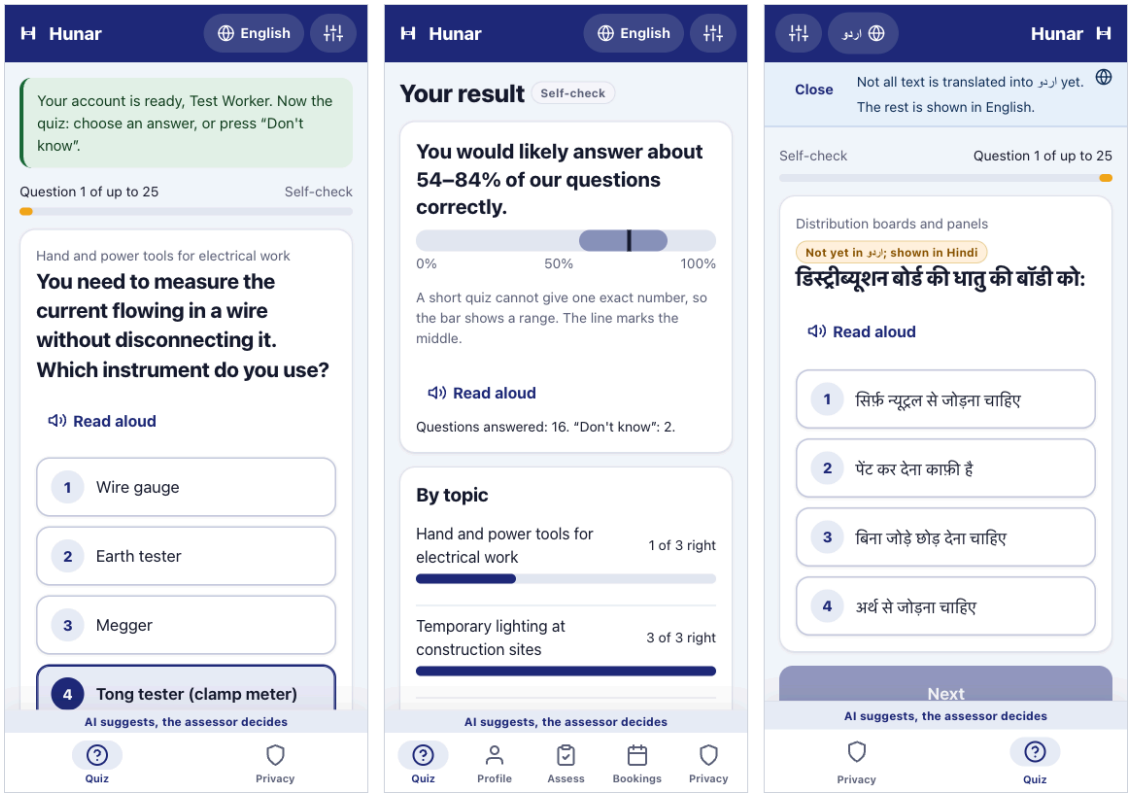
with confidence and the reasons behind it, level descriptors, and the accept/override controls. The screen shows one practical task at a time.

Screens for workers and customers. First use starts with a language picker (each language in its own script, with an honest "mostly English for now" until its translation exists), then the choice between "I am a worker" and "I want to hire a worker", (for workers) the trade, the itemised consent screen, and registration with a phone number and PIN. A new worker lands on the first quiz question; after the quiz, the next step offered is the profile. Workers then get bottom navigation for the quiz, their profile, assessment requests, bookings and privacy (only the quiz and privacy before the first quiz is finished); customers for finding a worker, bookings and privacy; staff keep the assessor screens, plus assessment requests and (for admins) permit checks. Every screen was exercised in a browser at 375 px width, including Urdu in right-to-left layout.



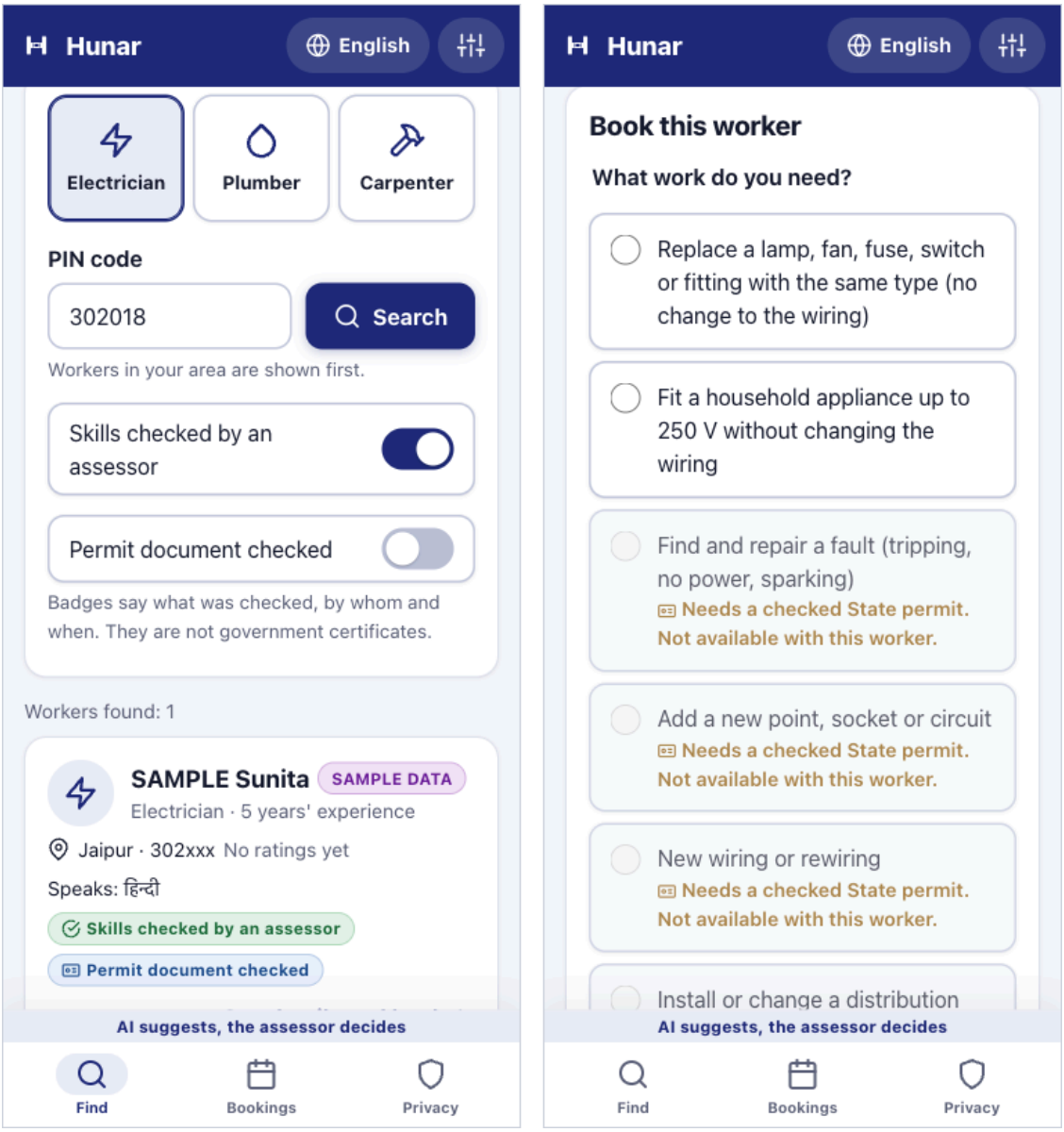
Onboarding: language, trade, consent

Figure 3b. Onboarding: language picker; a worker's trade, with the note that the compulsory quiz starts as soon as the account exists; and consent per purpose with the data each uses (the skill quiz is required for workers).



Worker quiz

Figure 3c. Worker quiz: the first question, right after registering (until a quiz is finished only the quiz and privacy are open); the result as a range with per-NOS bars (test account, answers given by a script at reading pace); Urdu layout with a question shown in Hindi because its translation is missing.



Customer search and booking

Figure 3d. Customer: search with badges that say what was checked (SAMPLE DATA worker), and booking where jobs needing a State permit are disabled for a worker whose permit is not checked.

6. Experiments and results

All tables in this section are generated from `experiments/*.json` by `scripts/build_results_table.py`.

M1 mapper on the team-written declaration set

RESULT PENDING: `experiments/m1_mapper_real.json` does not exist yet.

M1 mapper on the SYNTHETIC declaration set (pipeline check, not real workers)

> **SYNTHETIC DATA: declarations written by an AI model, not by workers. These numbers check the pipeline; they are not evidence about real workers.**

n = 150 declarations (English 50, Hindi (Devanagari) 50, Hinglish 50), 5 qualification packs (chance top-1 = 0.20). 95% bootstrap CIs in brackets. Source: `experiments/m1_mapper_synthetic.json`.

Method	Top-1	Top-3	MRR
Keyword overlap (baseline)	0.489 [0.42, 0.56]	0.808 [0.76, 0.85]	0.673 [0.63, 0.72]
TF-IDF (baseline)	0.543 [0.47, 0.61]	0.815 [0.77, 0.86]	0.702 [0.66, 0.75]
Multilingual MiniLM-L12 (primary)	0.507 [0.43, 0.59]	0.853 [0.80, 0.91]	0.695 [0.64, 0.75]
LaBSE	0.440 [0.35, 0.52]	0.740 [0.67, 0.81]	0.630 [0.57, 0.69]
TF-IDF + MiniLM hybrid (exploratory, post hoc)	0.593 [0.51, 0.67]	0.920 [0.87, 0.96]	0.761 [0.71, 0.81]

By language (fairness analysis): top-1 / top-3 / MRR

Method	English	Hindi (Devanagari)	Hinglish
Keyword overlap (baseline)	0.64 / 0.90 / 0.78	0.23 / 0.62 / 0.48	0.60 / 0.90 / 0.76
TF-IDF (baseline)	0.72 / 0.92 / 0.83	0.25 / 0.62 / 0.49	0.66 / 0.90 / 0.79
Multilingual MiniLM-L12 (primary)	0.64 / 0.90 / 0.77	0.42 / 0.88 / 0.66	0.46 / 0.78 / 0.66
LaBSE	0.46 / 0.70 / 0.64	0.48 / 0.74 / 0.66	0.38 / 0.78 / 0.60
TF-IDF + MiniLM hybrid (exploratory, post hoc)	0.72 / 0.96 / 0.84	0.44 / 0.88 / 0.67	0.62 / 0.92 / 0.77

M1 voice input on SYNTHETIC speech (pipeline check, not real workers)

> **SYNTHETIC SPEECH: AI-written declarations read aloud by macOS text-to-speech voices, not recordings of workers. Clean synthetic audio is an optimistic bound; this checks the pipeline.**

150 AI-written declarations read by macOS text-to-speech, transcribed with faster-whisper small (CPU, int8), then mapped with Multilingual MiniLM-L12 (primary). Transcription took 0.61 s per second of audio on this laptop (arm64; not a controlled benchmark). Error rates count words or characters wrong per reference word or character; digits are not spelled out. Source: `experiments/m1_voice_synthetic.json`.

Language	n	Word error rate	Character error rate	Top-1 typed	Top-1 spoken	Top-1 changed (right to wrong / wrong to right)
English	50	0.05	0.02	0.64 [0.50, 0.78]	0.52 [0.38, 0.66]	11 (8 / 2)
Hindi (Devanagari)	50	0.43	0.19	0.42 [0.28, 0.56]	0.28 [0.16, 0.42]	28 (12 / 5)
Hinglish	50	n/a (script)	n/a (script)	0.46 [0.32, 0.60]	0.26 [0.14, 0.38]	25 (14 / 4)

M2 evidence reuse detection (perceptual hashing)

Real photos from the public PPE dataset (CC BY 4.0, test split); reuse is simulated by image transformations. Not photos from our own assessments. The test split had 1935 images but only 407 distinct ones after grouping near-identical frames; 162 stored ('gallery') photos, 245 fresh photos, 9 reuse transformations. Threshold rule: max recall s.t. false-flag rate on fresh dev photos <= 0.05; reported on the held-out half. Source: `experiments/m2_hashing.json`.

Hash	Threshold (bits of 64)	Precision	Recall	False flags on fresh photos
phash	4	0.993	0.407	0.016
dhash	3	0.991	0.438	0.024
ahash	0	0.984	0.344	0.033
whash	0	0.974	0.365	0.024

pHash recall by kind of reuse (threshold 4, held-out half):

Reuse transformation	Recall
jpeg q50	1.00
jpeg q20	1.00
resize 50pct	1.00
crop 90pct	0.00
crop 75pct	0.00
brightness +30pct	0.65
rotate 5deg	0.01
border whatsapp style	0.00
mirror flip	0.00

For comparison, the max-F1 threshold (16) would catch more edited copies (recall 0.70) but would also flag 46% of fresh, unrelated photos, because many site photos look alike.

M2 PPE / tool presence detector (YOLOv8n)

RESULT PENDING: train with `notebooks/m2_train_yolo_colab.ipynb` on Colab, then bring the results back with `scripts/import_detector_results.py` (see `docs/m2_colab_walkthrough.md`).

Training data splits (boxes per class). The dataset's published splits are class-disjoint, so a group-aware, class-stratified re-split is used. Source: `experiments/m2_ppe_split.json`.

Published splits:

Split	Images	helmet	gloves	safety_shoes	goggles
train	6473	0	3679	14	2692
valid	3570	283	984	639	1192
test	1935	1240	0	102	300

Test images with a near-duplicate (<= 4 bits) in train, published splits: 136.

Re-split (pHash groups (single linkage, <= 4 bits), iterative stratification over groups (rarest class first, targets train/valid/test 0.70/0.15/0.15, ties to test), seed 0; 2911 groups, largest 2579 images):

Split	Images	helmet	gloves	safety_shoes	goggles
train	8384	1066	3264	498	2929
valid	1797	229	700	11	628
test	1797	228	699	246	627

Test images with a near-duplicate (<= 4 bits) in train, re-split: 0.

Diagnostic first run on the published splits (not the detector result). YOLOv8n, 50 epochs, ultralytics 8.3.228. Full test mAP50 0.530, clean test (1799 images) mAP50 0.397; per class on the clean test: helmet mAP50 0.000 | goggles mAP50 0.795. Helmet scores 0 because the published training split contains no helmet boxes; gloves cannot be scored because the published test split contains none; safety shoes had very few training boxes. Only the goggles figure measures what the model learned. Source: `experiments/m2_detector_run1_published_splits.json`; confusion matrix: `docs/figures/m2_run1_confusion_matrix.png`.

Video pilot: frame check on hand-labelled frames

RESULT PENDING: no labelled frames yet. Record guided clips, run `make clip-frames`, label `data/labels/clip_frames.csv`, then `make eval-clips`.

M4 inter-assessor consistency study

RESULT PENDING: no real rater scores yet. Rater mode is built; the study needs 3 to 5 real assessors and 20 to 30 consented evidence photos.

M4 study design (SIMULATION OF THE METHOD, not a result)

> **SIMULATION OF THE METHOD, NOT A RESULT: artificial ratings from an assumed model, used to size the study. Says nothing about whether the rubric helps real assessors.**

Share of 500 simulated studies per cell in which the 95% CI of the assisted-minus-unassisted Krippendorff alpha excludes 0, assuming alpha 0.50 without the rubric. The no-effect row checks the method: it should stay near 0.025. Source: `experiments/m4_design_simulation.json`; figure `docs/figures/m4_design_power.png`.

Raters	Items	with rubric 0.50	with rubric 0.60	with rubric 0.70	with rubric 0.80
3	20	0.03	0.14	0.35	0.71
3	25	0.02	0.14	0.43	0.84
3	30	0.02	0.18	0.55	0.91
4	20	0.03	0.18	0.50	0.89
4	25	0.02	0.17	0.60	0.95
4	30	0.03	0.22	0.69	0.97
5	20	0.02	0.24	0.60	0.95
5	25	0.02	0.21	0.75	0.96
5	30	0.03	0.27	0.79	1.00

Worker quiz: design check (SIMULATION OF THE METHOD, not a result)

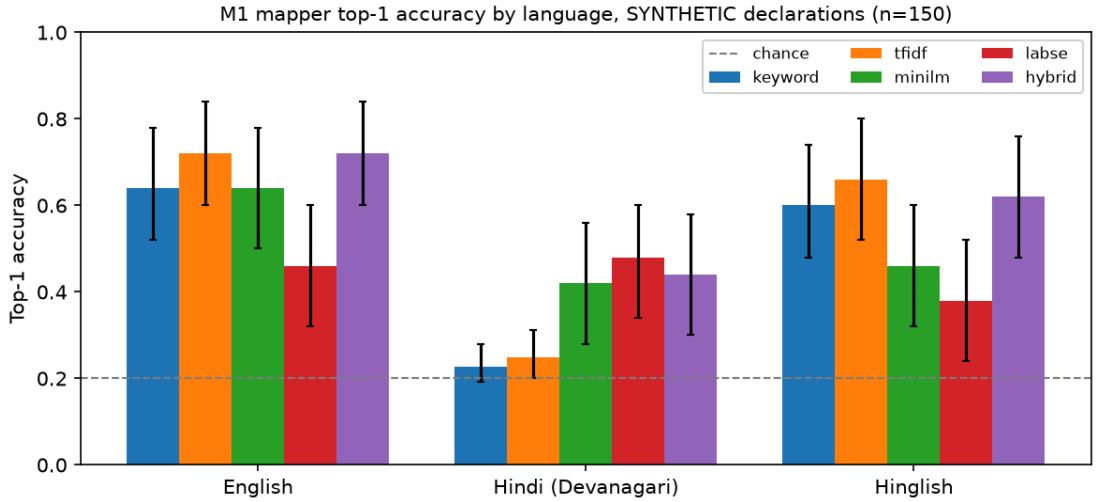
> **SIMULATION OF THE METHOD, NOT A RESULT: simulated workers answering under assumed scenarios. It checks the quiz design; it says nothing about real workers.**

1000 simulated workers per cell, ability ~ N(0, 1). Adaptive quiz: Rasch model, EAP scoring, stop at posterior SD <= 0.5 after 12 items or at 25 items; compared with a fixed 20-item quiz. Scenarios: difficulties as estimated (*calibrated*), off by N(0, 0.7^2) logits (*cold start*), and cold start with a 0.2 guessing floor. Coverage = share of 90% intervals containing the true ability. Source: `experiments/quiz_cat_simulation.json`; figure `docs/figures/quiz_cat_simulation.png`.

Trade	Scenario	Questions (adaptive / fixed)	RMSE (adaptive / fixed)	90% coverage (adaptive / fixed)
carpenter	calibrated	15.7 / 20	0.50 / 0.47	0.90 / 0.89
carpenter	cold start	15.5 / 20	0.53 / 0.48	0.88 / 0.89
carpenter	cold start guessing	15.7 / 20	0.71 / 0.68	0.76 / 0.72
electrician	calibrated	15.4 / 20	0.50 / 0.46	0.89 / 0.89
electrician	cold start	15.2 / 20	0.53 / 0.49	0.88 / 0.89
electrician	cold start guessing	15.4 / 20	0.70 / 0.74	0.76 / 0.70
plumber	calibrated	16.0 / 20	0.49 / 0.46	0.90 / 0.90
plumber	cold start	16.0 / 20	0.53 / 0.48	0.88 / 0.89
plumber	cold start guessing	15.8 / 20	0.73 / 0.71	0.74 / 0.70

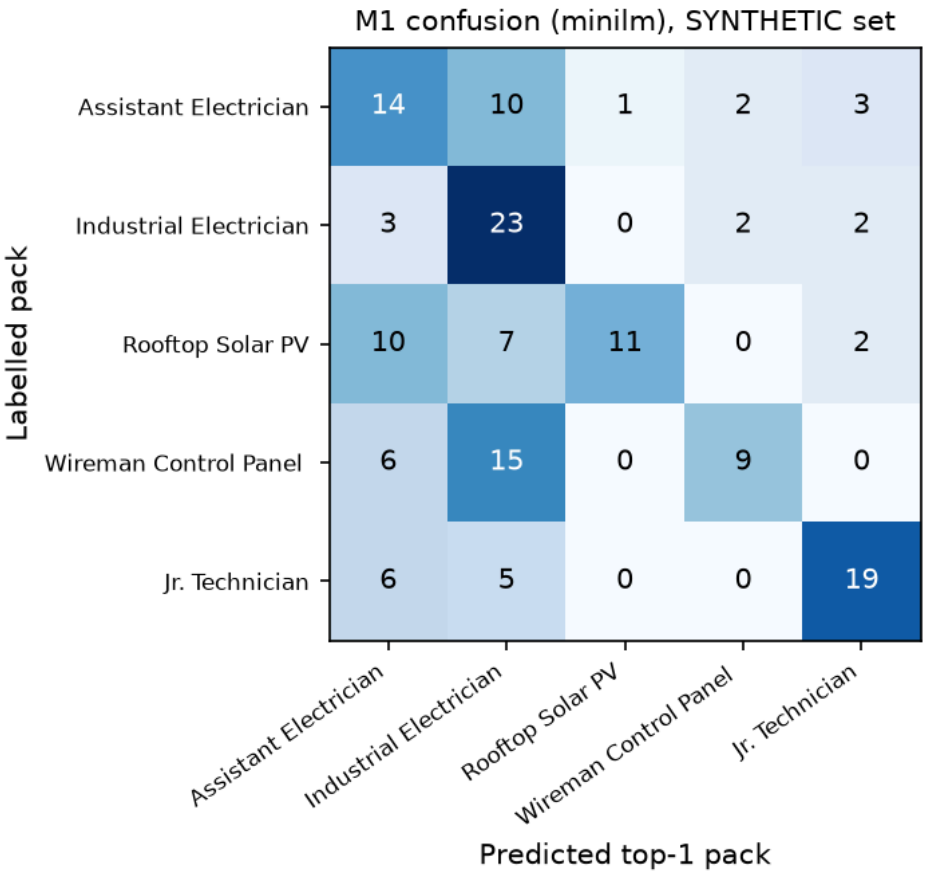
Worker quiz: calibration from real answers

Trade	Status
carpenter	RESULT PENDING (0 finished real attempts; 100 needed)
electrician	RESULT PENDING (0 finished real attempts; 100 needed)
plumber	RESULT PENDING (0 finished real attempts; 100 needed)



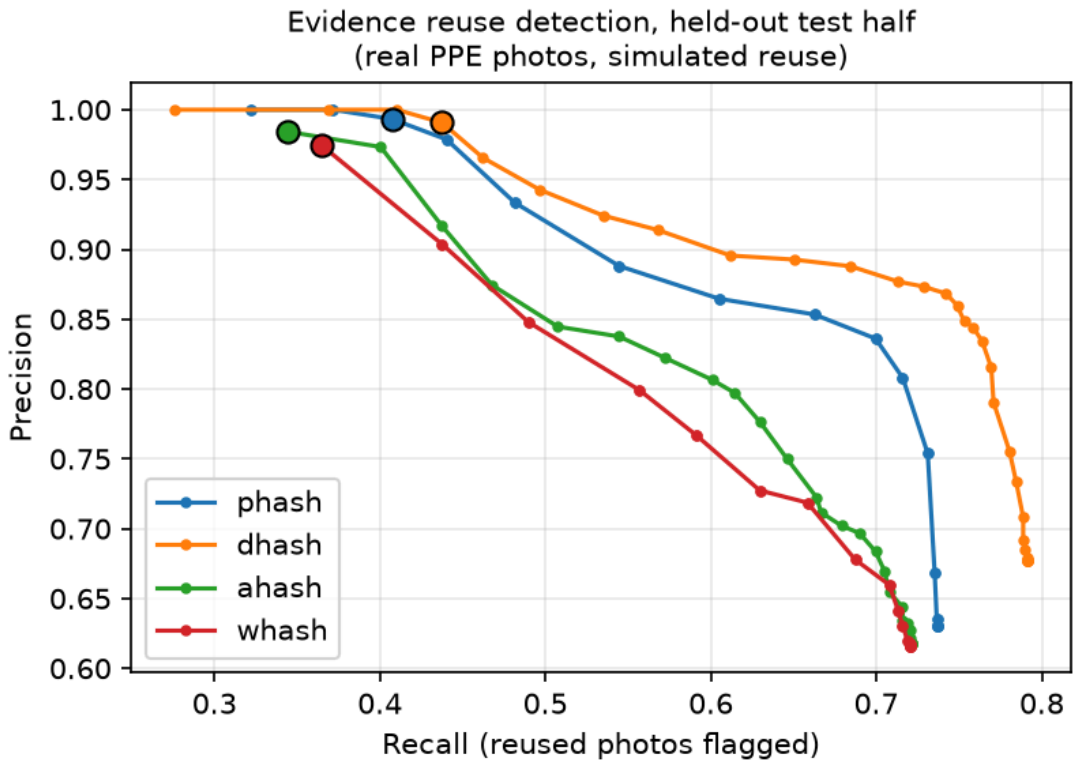
M1 top-1 accuracy by language on the synthetic set

Figure 4. M1 top-1 accuracy by language, synthetic declarations (95 % bootstrap CIs; dashed line: chance).



M1 confusion matrix, MiniLM

Figure 5. M1 confusion matrix for MiniLM on the synthetic set.



Reuse detection precision-recall

Figure 6. Evidence reuse detection on the held-out half; dots mark the chosen thresholds.

6.1 Discussion

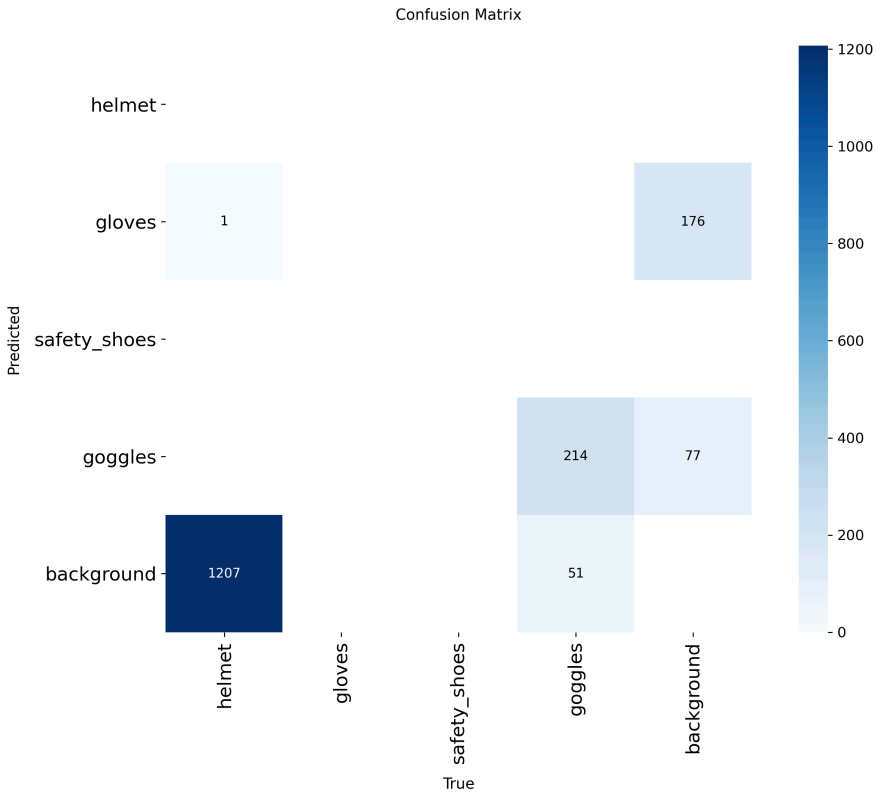
Q1, mapper. On the synthetic set the lexical baselines do well in English and Hinglish, where the workers' words overlap with the English criteria, but fall to near chance in Devanagari Hindi: TF-IDF top-1 is 0.25 against a chance level of 0.20. The multilingual model is the only single method that works across all three languages (Hindi top-3 0.88 against 0.62 for TF-IDF), which is the fairness argument for using it. It is weaker than TF-IDF on Hinglish (0.46 against 0.66), probably because romanised Hindi was rare in its training data. LaBSE did not help. The exploratory hybrid combines the strengths of both (overall top-1 0.59, top-3 0.92), but it was designed after seeing these results and must be confirmed on the real team-written set. The confusion matrix shows the most common error: declarations are pulled towards *Industrial Electrician*. Pack size alone does not explain this (the target qualification has more core criteria); a likely cause is that its criteria use broad, generic wiring, testing and safety vocabulary. The error-analysis notebook (`notebooks/m1_error_analysis.ipynb`) also shows that TF-IDF gives every pack a score of zero for most Devanagari declarations. The confidence intervals are wide (n = 50 per language), and the synthetic declarations were written by a model rather than by workers, so these numbers say that the pipeline works and where it is weak, not how it will perform in the field.

Q1b, spoken declarations (synthetic speech). On clean text-to-speech audio, Whisper `small` transcribed English almost perfectly (word error rate 0.05) but Hindi poorly (word error rate 0.43, character error rate 0.19). In the Hindi transcripts we read, many errors swap aspirated and unaspirated consonants (काम → खाम, धूल → दूल) or dental and retroflex ones (टाइट → ताएद), or drop vowel signs (पैनल → पनल), so words the multilingual model knows come out as non-words; occasionally a whole sentence is missing. Top-1 mapping accuracy fell in every language (English 0.64 → 0.52, Hindi 0.42 → 0.28,

Hinglish 0.46 → 0.26), while top-3 accuracy hardly moved (Hindi 0.88 → 0.80). The English drop is the surprising part. In the English declarations whose top pack changed, the transcripts differ mostly in punctuation, capitals and number format (a colon becomes a comma, “DIN” becomes “din”, “three” becomes “3”); even a transcript with no word errors changed the top pack. Some of these changes move sentence boundaries (a full stop becomes a comma, or the reverse), which changes the units the mapper averages over; others only change the tokens the embedding model sees. Either is enough to change the top pack. One real domain error recurred: the Indian English voice’s “wire” was heard as “via”. The changes went both ways (8 right to wrong and 2 wrong to right in English), which shows how close the scores of neighbouring packs are: the top-1 choice is fragile whether the declaration is typed or spoken, and the assessor’s confirmation step matters. Two consequences follow: the read-back step is essential for Hindi, and the mapper should be made less sensitive to surface form, for example by normalising punctuation, case and numbers before matching. All of this is on synthetic speech; real speech will be harder.

Q2, reuse detection. At an operating point with very few false alarms, pHash reliably catches re-submission of the same photo after recompression or resizing, which is the most likely form of casual reuse (for example a photo forwarded through a messaging app). It does not catch deliberate edits such as cropping, rotating or adding borders; raising the threshold to catch them would flag a large share of genuinely different site photos, because construction-site photos look alike. The public dataset itself was mostly near-identical video frames, a reminder that the same kind of leakage could inflate detector scores if not controlled.

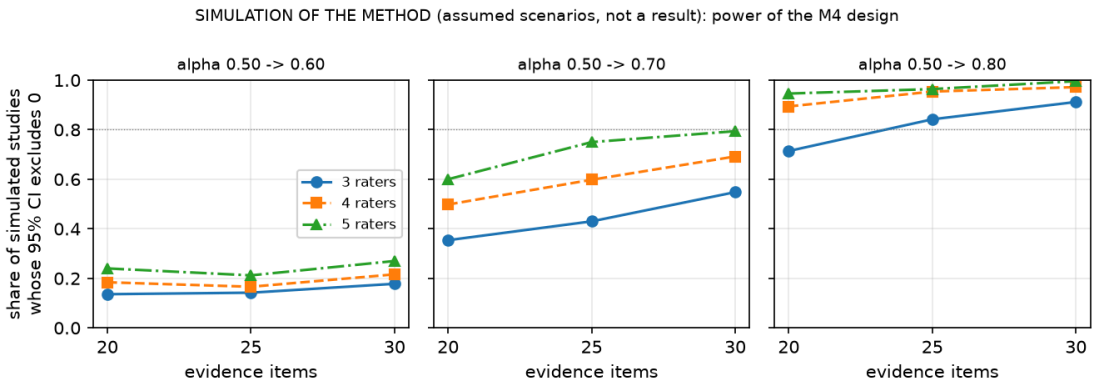
Q3, detector. The headline result needs the second Colab run on the re-split data (pending). The first run, on the published splits, is reported above only as a diagnostic: its helmet score is zero because the model never saw a helmet in training, gloves could not be scored because the test split had none, and only goggles measure what the model learned (clean-test mAP50 0.795). The lesson for the report is that a public dataset’s published split must be checked for class coverage and near-duplicate leakage before any number from it is trusted.



Run 1 confusion matrix, published splits (diagnostic)

Figure 7. Confusion matrix of the diagnostic first run on the published splits (clean test set). All true helmets fall in "background" because the training split contained no helmet boxes.

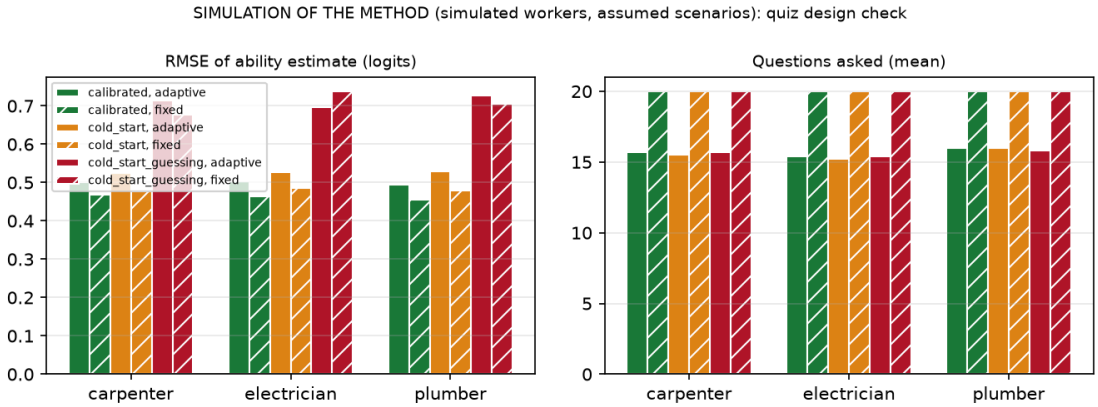
Q4, assessor agreement is pending until real assessors take part. The design simulation (Table "M4 study design" above and Figure 8) shows what the planned study can and cannot show. If the rubric raised alpha from 0.50 to 0.80, a study with 3 raters and 20 items would detect it in 71% of simulated studies and one with 5 raters and 30 items in 99.6%; a rise to 0.60 would mostly go unseen (27% even with 5 raters and 30 items). With no real effect, about 2% of simulated studies wrongly showed one, close to the nominal 2.5 %, which checks the analysis itself. We therefore aim for 4 to 5 raters and 30 items and will report the interval of the difference, not just its sign.



M4 design simulation (simulation of the method, not a result)

Figure 8. SIMULATION OF THE METHOD, not a result: share of simulated studies of each size whose 95 % interval for the improvement in Krippendorff's alpha excludes zero, for three assumed effects.

Q5, quiz design (simulation of the method). Simulated workers answered through the same engine the app uses. For electricians, when the item difficulties are right, the adaptive quiz asked 15.4 questions on average against 20 for a fixed quiz, for an RMSE of 0.50 against 0.46 logits, and its 90 % intervals contained the true ability 89% of the time. With the difficulties off by about 0.7 logits, as they may be before calibration, coverage was 88%. With guessing, which the Rasch scorer does not model, the RMSE rose to 0.70 and coverage fell to 76%: weaker workers (true ability below -1) were overestimated by 0.96 logits on average, against 0.36 without guessing (the prior's usual pull towards the middle). The adaptive quiz therefore saves about a fifth of the questions at a small cost in precision, the stated uncertainty is honest only when difficulties are calibrated and guessing is low, and the quiz is fit for self-check and assessor context, not for any decision about a worker. Calibration from real answers is pending for every trade.



Quiz design check (simulation of the method, not a result)

Figure 9. SIMULATION OF THE METHOD, not a result: error of the ability estimate and number of questions, adaptive against fixed-length quiz, for three trades and three assumed scenarios.

7. Limitations

- **No real worker data yet.** M1 results come from synthetic declarations written by an AI model; real performance will differ and is likely lower. The team-written set is the next step.
- **Video pilot untried.** The guided-clip pipeline has run only on synthetic clips; the frame check is wired in but its model is neither downloaded nor measured, no Indian-language speech engine is plugged in yet, and the fan tasks are drafts against a qualification that names no fans.
- **Single trade, five qualifications.** Distractors are neighbouring electrical qualifications; with hundreds of packs on the NQR the task becomes harder.
- **Parsing not fully human-checked.** Performance criteria were spot-checked, not checked one by one.
- **Rubric descriptors are drafts.** They were drafted by the team with AI help from official performance criteria and need review by a certified assessor or the sector skill council.
- **Presence, not quality.** The detector, once trained, can only say that gloves or a multimeter are visible. It cannot tell whether a joint is sound.
- **Face blurring** uses Haar cascades, which miss profile, small and occluded faces. Photos taken offline wait unblurred in the device's queue until sync.
- **Hashing** misses edited reuse (crops, rotations, borders, mirroring).
- **Detector training data** is a public dataset dominated by a few videos; safety shoes come from only two, so per-class scores for shoes rest on a single test video. No electrician-specific photos (tools, Indian domestic settings) are in it yet.

- **Assessor agreement is unmeasured.** This is the outcome the problem statement cares most about, and it requires real assessors and consented photos.
- **Study sizing rests on assumptions.** The design simulation assumes a distribution of item levels, normally distributed rater bias and noise, and no memory of items between sessions. Real raters may agree more or less than assumed; the simulation guides the size of the study, nothing more.
- **Voice input is checked only on synthetic speech.** Text-to-speech audio is clean, evenly paced and free of background noise; real workers on site speak faster, mix languages and have regional accents. Even on clean audio, Whisper `small` makes many errors in Hindi. Recognition also needs the server, so it does not work offline.
- **Quiz items are drafts and uncalibrated.** They were written with AI help from official sources and have not yet been reviewed by an assessor or ITI instructor; difficulties are estimates until about 100 real attempts per trade exist. The quiz is unsupervised, so it cannot tell who answered.
- **Trade qualification files.** The carpenter file's NQR validity ended on 31 Aug 2026 and no current worker-level domestic carpentry qualification was found. The parser now handles the layouts that first caused gaps in the plumber and carpenter files (wrapped names, tables continued across pages, rows printed above a table, headings glued onto criteria), but every criterion still needs a human check against the PDF.
- **Plumber and carpenter rubrics are AI drafts.** Their eight practical tasks were written with AI help from the official files and have not been reviewed by a plumbing or carpentry assessor; until then their pre scores and profiles carry a DRAFT note. The carpenter file's NQR validity has ended.
- **No identity or permit verification service.** Hunar does not check Aadhaar or a State permit register; an admin checks the permit document by eye, and badges say exactly that.
- **Languages.** The Bhashini client follows the documented API but has not been run against the live service (no credentials yet); machine translations will need native-speaker review.
- **Theory component.** NSQF assessment also includes theory and viva marks; Hunar supports only the practical component.

8. Ethics, consent and responsible use

- **Consent.** A consent form template (`docs/consent_form.md`) covers the purposes, blurring, storage, withdrawal and deletion. The application refuses a photo until consent is confirmed.
- **Privacy.** Workers are identified only by pseudonymous codes; faces are blurred before storage; raw data and the database are excluded from version control.
- **Human oversight.** The tool cannot certify anyone. The assessor confirms the pack, decides every criterion, and signs off; disagreeing with the tool is a first-class action. Overrides are logged with reasons, which also makes automation bias [52] auditable: a high rate of unexamined acceptance would be visible in the log.
- **Fairness.** Accuracy is reported per language; a model that only worked in English would be excluded on fairness grounds.
- **Honest limits.** The interface states that the photo model judges presence only.
- **Customers and workers.** Consent is itemised per purpose and can be withdrawn in one step; profiles show an area, not an address; phone numbers are shared only after a booking is accepted; only adults can register. Quiz results stay between the worker and the assessor, and the badge a customer sees always says who checked what, and that it is not a government certificate.

9. Status and future work

Phase	Goal	Status
0	Setup, schemas, official data	Done
1	M1 mapper, baselines, evaluation	Done on synthetic data; real labelled set pending; optional voice input added and checked on synthetic speech
2	M3 rubric engine, backend API, audit log	Done
3	M2 evidence checker	Hashing and blurring done; detector run 1 diagnostic; run 2 on the re-split data pending
4	Frontend and offline sync	Done; full flow and offline replay exercised in a browser at phone width
5	M4 study	Rater mode, photo import and analysis done; study sized by simulation; data collection pending
6	Report and viva preparation	This draft
7	Workers and customers	Accounts, consent, quiz (three trades), booking, assessment requests and 23-language support built and tested; quiz banks await expert review; calibration pending real attempts; Bhashini credentials pending

Next steps, in order:

1. The team writes and cross-labels about 150 real declarations, reporting labelling agreement.
2. Run the detector notebook again on the re-split data (run 2); report per-class mAP.
3. Review the rubrics with a certified assessor; collect consented photos of practice tasks.
4. Run the assessor-agreement study, aiming for 4 to 5 assessors and 30 items (Section 4.5).
5. Try voice input with consenting workers' real speech; if Hindi errors stay frequent, test a larger or Hindi-specialised speech model. Add on-device face blurring.
6. Get the quiz banks reviewed by an ITI instructor and an assessor; collect about 100 real attempts per trade, then calibrate.
7. Register with Bhashini, run `make translate`, and have each language reviewed by a native speaker.
8. Extend to more trades by running the same parser on more NQR qualification files.

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